

Kevin Rufino

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EXPERIENCE

Product / Design Engineer

Candid **August 2025 - Present, New York, NY**

- Defined an AI-native design system to code workflow — Figma Code Connect — boosting LLM legibility and dev velocity by ~85%.
- Shipped an agentic B2B chat experience with a custom MCP server enabling natural-language tool use — owned SSE, Zustand state, and Generative UI.
- Partnered cross functionally to deliver agentic experiences to data heavy dashboard UI's delivering integral data to the public sector.
- Audited repo architecture for agent-readiness — implementing context maps, conventions, and docs turning AI coding tools into reliable contributors.

Front-End Web Engineer II

Nike **May 2024 - August 2025, New York, NY**

- Created \$2M+ in pre-order sales for the first time in the company's history by leading creative marketing page experience.
- Architected and developed a scalable partnered marketing experience using SSR to improve page SEO, resulting in a 25% increase in satisfaction.
- Created optimization pipeline for 3D assets, guiding engineers and designers on asset size recommendations and compression techniques.
- Developed multiple a11y-compliant design system UI components utilizing Storybook to streamline the dev process, reducing TTM for new features.
- Enhanced user interface stability by increasing test coverage of UI components using Jest, React Testing Library, and Cypress.
- Mentored 2 interns in best practices, fostering a collaborative learning environment that resulted in the successful completion of assigned projects.

Front-End Web Engineer I

Nike **September 2022 - May 2024, New York, NY**

- Built 3D creative marketing components utilizing React, CSS animations, ThreeJS, R3F, GLSL shaders, and Canvas components.
- Engineered a CMS using GraphQL and Contentful, reducing assets and copy update times by an estimated 4 hours per website update.
- Constructed a workflow for fast R&D of creative development projects for quick response to design feedback.
- Introduced analytics framework tracking consumer behavior across the platform, allowing for close and accurate consumer insights.
- Assisted consumer research and insights in marketing and design briefs by working cross-functionally functionally.

Full Stack Application Security Software Engineer

Nike **September 2021 - September 2022, Beaverton, OR**

- Engineered a UI intake form for developers to submit their code for a Dynamic Application Security Testing (DAST) service.
- Created an AWS CloudWatch dashboard tracking downtime and errors across multiple services on our platform.
- Implemented CI/CD for infrastructure as code on the team's AWS CDK stacks.
- Developed front-end using ReactJS, connecting to the backend Mongo DB and third-party security testing services such as Acunetix.

PROJECTS

moodi - Mood Board Recommendation Algorithm

- Built moodi.me, an infinite N-dimensional canvas for exploring an image archive, served as SEO-optimized, pre-generated WebP built for discovery.
- Designed momentum snap-pan with spring-eased focus transitions that re-align the grid post-gesture and honor prefers-reduced-motion.
- Authored a taste-based recommendation engine that projects image embeddings into a navigable similarity space of any dimension.
- Built a FastAPI CLIP worker (ViT-L/14, 768-dim) on Supabase pgvector; HNSW cut kNN p95 16x (103ms to 6ms) at 99.9% recall.
- Held 60fps pan-zoom via viewport culling, async image decode, and compositor-layer tuning, eliminating 150ms+ frame stalls.

Online Minecraft for Web

- Engineered a fully playable, scalable 3D voxel game in the browser, simulating Minecraft using R3F, WebGL, and Socket.IO for real-time multiplayer.
- Designed a procedural terrain generation algorithm that constructs a randomized, interactive voxel world on demand.
- Built a custom physics engine integration using Cannon.JS for realistic player-world interactions.
- Architected a real-time server-client communication layer with web sockets to sync player actions and world updates.
- Optimized 3D rendering performance and memory usage to support stable frame rates across complex environments.
- Drove the project end-to-end to explore large-scale front-end architecture, real-time systems, and GPU-bound rendering in browsers.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Grand Valley State University • Allendale, MI • 2021

INVOLVEMENT

Chapter Founder and President

Allendale, MI • Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers (SHPE) • December 2019 - May 2021

- Visited local predominantly Black and Hispanic lower income schools to inform children on STEM paths and provide mentorship.
- Set up resume and networking workshops with Hispanic professionals in our community.
- Founded local chapter recruiter requiring me to recruit 10 members to be officially recognized by the organization and my school.

SKILLS

Frontend: TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, Zustand, Framer Motion, SSR | **Design Systems:** Figma, Figma Code Connect, Storybook, design tokens, WCAG / a11y | **AI / Agentic:** MCP, Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, LLM integration, function calling / tool use, prompt + context engineering | **Real-time / Backend:** Node.js, GraphQL, SSE, WebSockets, Resend, React Email, SQL, Python | **3D / Creative:** Three.js, R3F, Drei, WebGL, GLSL, Blender, Photoshop | **Testing:** Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress